Burak Kazim Yilmaz

Department of Political Science, Emory University, Atlanta, GA

burak.kazim.yilmaz@emory.edu | burakkazimyilmaz.github.io/

Education

Emory University — Atlanta, GA
Ph.D. Candidate, Political Science — expected 2027

- Dissertation: *Essays on Elite Strategies in Counterinsurgency*
- Committee: Danielle Jung (Chair), Jessica Sun, and Alexander Bolton

Bilkent University — Ankara, Turkey
M.A. International Relations — 2021

Bilkent University — Ankara, Turkey
B.A. International Relations — 2019

Universidad Pontificia Comillas — Madrid, Spain
Erasmus Exchange Student — 2018

Peer-Reviewed Publications

Yilmaz, Burak Kazim and Efe Tokdemir. "Pave the Way to Diversion: Increased Salience of Foreign Policy at the Times of Economic Hardships." *Journal of Conflict Resolution*, Online First, 2026.

Yilmaz, Burak Kazim. "Insurgent Sabotage of Effective Local Governments: Evidence from Turkey." *Journal of Peace Research*, Forthcoming. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1093/jopres/xjag092.

Under Review

Yilmaz, Burak Kazim. "Making Populations Legible: Curfews, Displacement, and Counterinsurgency in Turkey." *Invited to Revise and Resubmit at Journal of Peace Research*.

Yilmaz, Burak Kazim. "Beyond Institutions: How Informal Alliances Shape Public Backing for Military Interventions." *Invited to Revise and Resubmit at Foreign Policy Analysis*.

Eddy Yeung and **Yilmaz, Burak Kazim**. "The Electoral Consequences of Foreign Side-Taking in the Shadow of Geopolitical Rivalry." *Invited to Revise and Resubmit at American Journal of Political Science*.

Hilal Sert and **Yilmaz, Burak Kazim**. "Signals of Vulnerability: Electoral Defeat and Coordinated Elite Defection in Turkey."*Under Review*.

Working Papers

Yilmaz, Burak Kazim. "Partisan Alignment and Public Responses to Domestic Political Violence."

Yilmaz, Burak Kazim. "Engaging the State: Local Institutions and Civilian Alignment in Colombia."

Hilal Sert and **Yilmaz, Burak Kazim**. "When Repression Divides: Peace Process and Opposition Fragmentation in Turkey"

Works in Progress

Yilmaz, Burak Kazim. "Counterterrorism Checkpoints and Civilian Perceptions."

Yilmaz, Burak Kazim. "Unilateral War and Democratic Confidence."

Yilmaz, Burak Kazim and Eddy Yeung. "Democracy Promotion or Foreign Meddling? Public Reactions to Pro-Democratic Electoral Intervention."

Yilmaz, Burak Kazim and Hilal Sert. "Relative Military Capabilities and Public Support for Retaliation Against Rebel Sponsors."

Grants, Awards, & Fellowships

Democracy and Electoral Integrity Fellowship, The Carter Center [2026-2027]
Supports the completion of doctoral dissertation.

APSA Conflict Processes Travel Grant | $300 [2026]
Supports conference participation at APSA annual meeting.

Institute for Humane Studies (IHS) Research Grant | $3,000 [2026]
Supports survey experiment for *Democracy Promotion or Foreign Meddling*.

Besample Dissertation Grant | Pilot Data Collection, $N = 500$ [2026]
Supported pilot survey experiment for *Counterterrorism Checkpoints and Civilian Perceptions*.

Professional Development Support (PDS) Funds, Laney Graduate School | $5,000 [2023-2025]
Supported conference travel and data collection across multiple projects.

Professional Development Support (PDS) Research Funds, Laney Graduate School | $5,500 [2025]
Supported survey experiment for *The Electoral Consequences of Foreign Side-Taking*.

Prudentis Awards, Emory University | $6,850 [2022-2025]
Supported conference travel and workshops across multiple projects.

Bilkent University Comprehensive Scholarship | approx. $50,000 2015–2019
Full tuition, housing, and stipend for four years.

Other Publications

Hilal Sert, **Burak Kazim Yilmaz**, and and Anthony J. DeMattee. 2026. "Repression Under the Cover of Peace: The Peace-Democracy Wedge in Turkish Politics." The Democracy Program, The Carter Center. Atlanta, GA.

Yilmaz, Burak Kazim. (2021, March 7). Book review: Libya's fragmentation: Structure and process in violent conflict by Wolfram Lacher. LSE Review of Books.

Conference Presentations

IHS Democratic Backsliding Graduate Papers Workshop	2026
American Political Science Association Annual Meeting (APSA)	2023, 2024, 2025, 2026
Emory Comparative Politics Workshop	2026
European Political Science Association Annual Conference (EPSA)	2025
Rising Scholars Workshop, Peace Science Society	2025
Sexton Security and Conflict Lab, Emory University	2025
Peace Science Society International Conference	2024, 2025
Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference (MPSA)	2024
Southeastern Rights Network (SERN) Workshop	2023, 2024
Emory International Relations Journal Club	2023, 2025
Atlanta Symposium on Political Science (ASOPS)	2023

Teaching Experience

Emory University

- Civilians in Conflict (Instructor of Record, Spring 2025)
- Principles of Political Science (Teaching Assistant, Fall 2025)
- Research Design and Methods (Teaching Assistant, Spring 2023)
- Introduction to International Relations (Teaching Assistant, Spring 2022)

Professional Service

Reviewer
Conflict Management and Peace Science

Training

ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods of Social Research 2024
University of Michigan, Ann Arbor.
Courses: (1) Panel data and longitudinal analysis and (2) Causal inference for the social sciences.

Summer Institute in Computational Social Science (SICSS) 2022
Georgia State University, Atlanta.
Learned skills such as text as data, web scraping, and the use of APIs.

Professional Experience

The Carter Center
Data Manager for nonpartisan observation efforts in Fulton County, GA in the US Elections 2024

Languages & Skills

Languages: Turkish (native), English (advanced), Spanish (beginner).
Software: Python, R, LaTeX, Mathematica, NVivo.

Updated September 2026